HUNT

SAFEPAY B2.EXE EXFIL HUNT

Source-observed Backblaze B2 command-line tooling used for victim data exfiltration.

CLASSIFICATION

Hunting query - Untested implementation sketch. Confidence Medium. Campaign-specific artifact.

PRIMARY PLATFORM

Microsoft Defender XDR. Required telemetry: DeviceProcessEvents.

OPERATIONAL VALUE 7/10

Fast fleet-wide identification of a source-observed exfiltration utility. Every match requires ownership, command-line and network validation.

Executive Assessment

Evidence, interpretation, inference and limits

SOURCE FACT

Joint government investigations as recent as August 2026 found SafePay actors executing commands through b2.exe to exfiltrate victim data.

SOURCE CAUTION

The advisory says leveraged tools and applications must not be attributed as malicious without analytical evidence supporting actor use or control.

DETECTION INFERENCE

An executed b2.exe should produce a process-creation record. Filename matching is suitable for hunting prevalence and collecting command-line context.

UNCONFIRMED

A row does not prove upload success, destination ownership, data access, SafePay activity, ransomware impact or attribution. The actor can rename the utility.

Threat Mechanics

Detection boundary within the reported intrusion lifecycle

1

Foothold

Credentials, VPN access and edge-device exploitation are reported initial-access paths.

2

Control

Actors use administrative accounts and legitimate remote execution tooling.

3

Collection

7-Zip, WinRAR and other utilities are reported for staging.

4

Exfiltration

The advisory explicitly states commands were executed through b2.exe to exfiltrate data.

5

Impact

SafePay encryption and recovery inhibition follow in the broader chain.

BOUNDARY

The query observes only b2.exe process execution. No claim is made about adjacent stages.

Telemetry & Evidence Model

Documented Defender for Endpoint process fields

DeviceProcessEvents	**Required**	Process creation events
FileName	**Required**	Exact executable name
ProcessCommandLine	**Required**	Arguments for triage
FolderPath / SHA1	**Enrichment**	Location and hash
DeviceId / DeviceName	**Required**	Endpoint context
InitiatingProcess*	**Enrichment**	Parent and account context
ReportId	**Enrichment**	Use with device and time

UNAVAILABLE

File contents, upload success, destination ownership and transferred data are not established by process telemetry.

Primary Hunting Query

Microsoft Defender XDR - exact filename, no threshold

```
DeviceProcessEvents
| where FileName =~ "b2.exe"
| project Timestamp, DeviceId, DeviceName,
          AccountDomain, AccountName, FileName, FolderPath,
          ProcessCommandLine, SHA1, InitiatingProcessFileName,
          InitiatingProcessCommandLine, InitiatingProcessAccountName, ReportId
| order by Timestamp desc
```

CONDITION EVIDENCE

b2.exe is explicitly named in AA26-293A as the command-line tool used to exfiltrate victim data. No hash, command grammar, destination, rarity or threshold is asserted.

STATUS

Hunting query - Untested implementation sketch. Keep non-alerting until local prevalence and authorized Backblaze use are known.

Triage & Investigation

Turn the filename match into evidence

01 Confirm signer, product metadata, hash and acquisition path.

02 Read the complete command line; identify profile, bucket and operation without exposing secrets.

03 Correlate outbound network events to Backblaze endpoints and verify bytes transferred separately.

04 Identify data accessed before execution and whether the account/device is authorized.

05 Escalate only when ownership, destination or surrounding activity is inconsistent with business use.

INVESTIGATION KEY

Use DeviceId and event time. ReportId is unique only with DeviceName and Timestamp. Filename alone is insufficient.

False Positives & Validation

Promotion requires measured local overlap

EXPECTED OVERLAP

Authorized backup, infrastructure automation, migration, developer use and approved Backblaze B2 transfers.

FAILURE CONDITIONS

Renamed binary, missing MDE coverage, command-line truncation, in-process API use or activity outside retention.

01 Run across full retention and identify approved owners.

02 Execute a controlled b2.exe command and confirm fields.

03 Collect process tree and network evidence for every unexplained match.

04 Reject alert promotion if legitimate use is common or destination semantics remain unavailable.

SUCCESS CRITERION

Controlled event visible, unauthorized prevalence measurable and investigation context complete.

ATT&CK, Conclusion & References

Evidence-backed mapping and publication record

MITRE ATT&CK T1048

Exfiltration Over Alternative Protocol is directly supported by the advisory's statement that SafePay actors used b2.exe for victim data exfiltration.

CONCLUSION

A precise artifact hunt is justified. It is not a production detection: b2.exe is legitimate, mutable and requires independent network and data-access evidence.

PRIMARY ADVISORY

AA26-293A. #StopRansomware: SafePay Ransomware. FBI, CISA, USSS and international partners. 20 October 2026.

hxxps://www[.]ic3[.]gov/CSA/2026/261020.pdf

OFFICIAL SCHEMA

Microsoft Learn. DeviceProcessEvents table in the advanced hunting schema.

hxxps://learn[.]microsoft[.]com/en-us/defender-xdr/advanced-hunting-deviceprocessevents-table

QUALITY CONTROLS

Eight pages; documented fields; no arbitrary thresholds; defanged links; no customer data; no secondary-platform pseudorules.